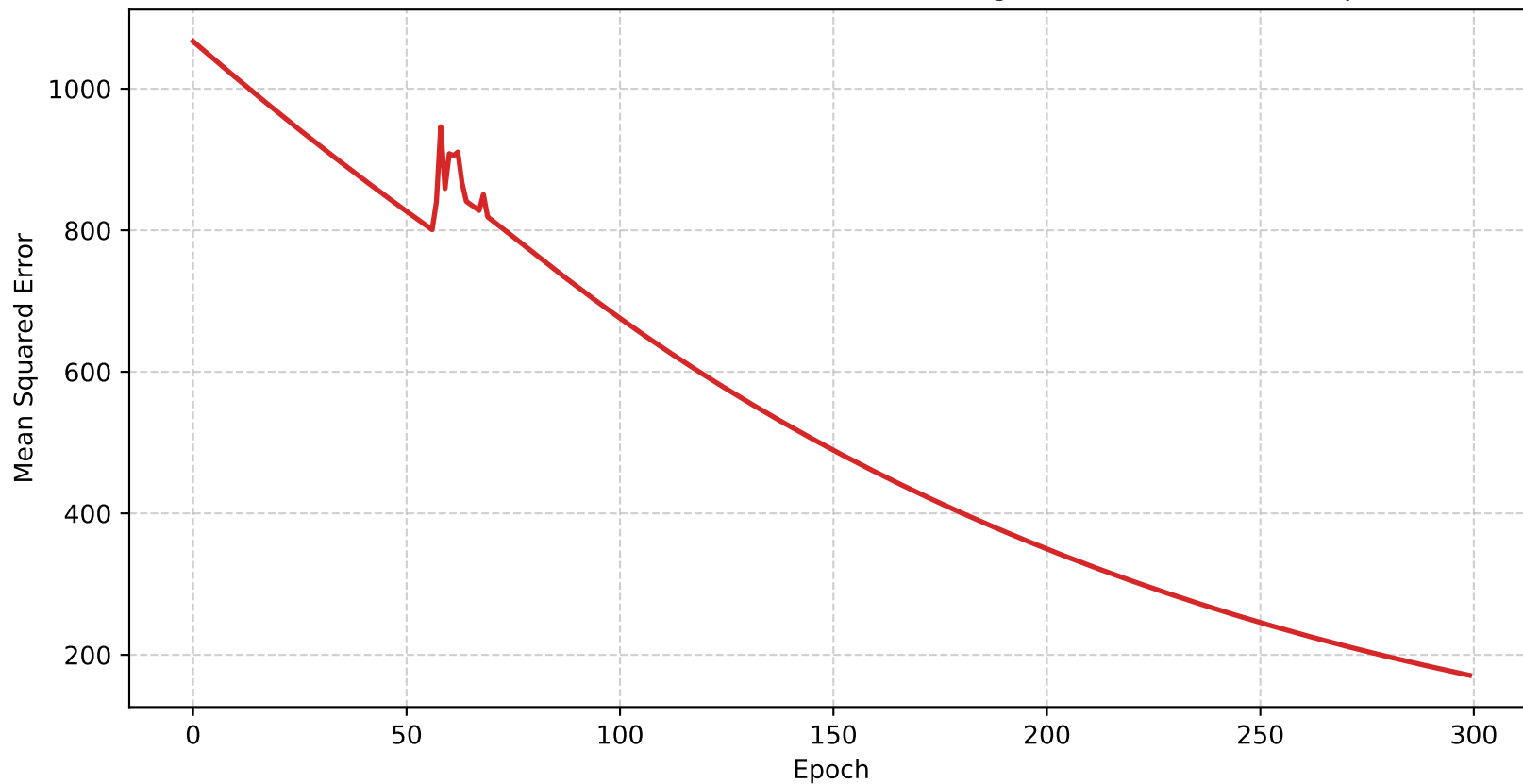
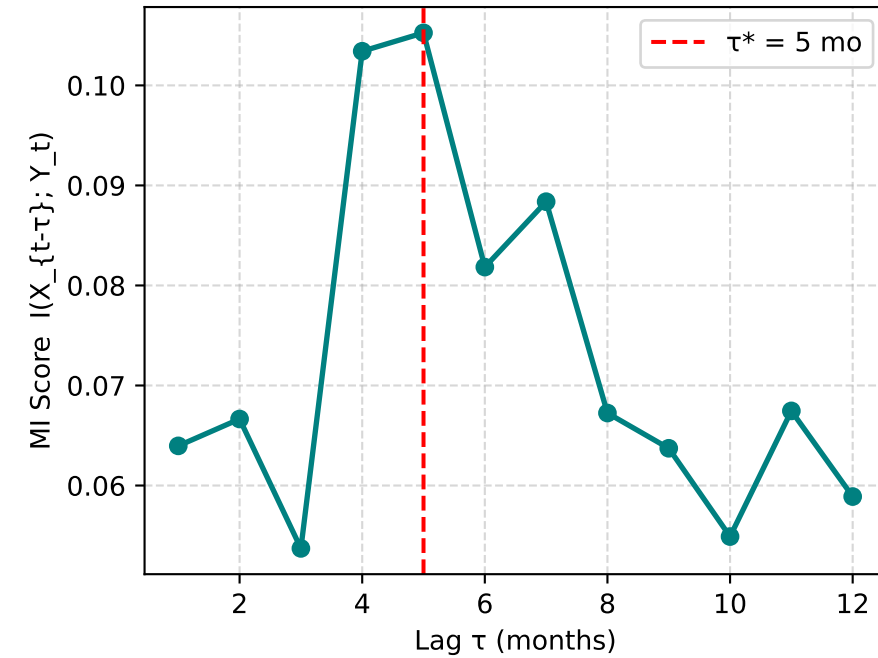


Model Convergence: Training Loss (MSE)
Downward trend confirms the model is learning the causal relationship.

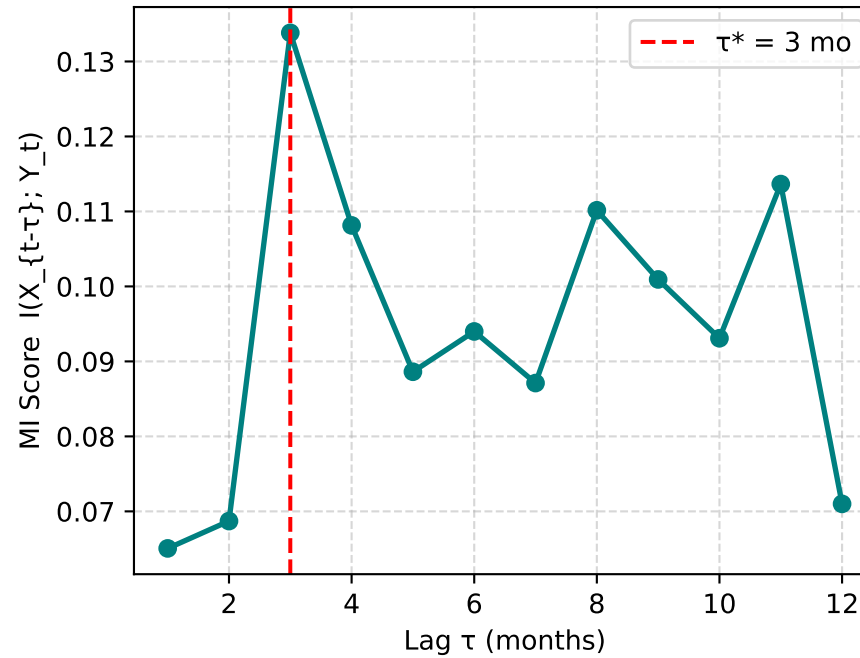


Phase 1 — Cross-Lagged Mutual Information: Optimal Delay τ^* per County

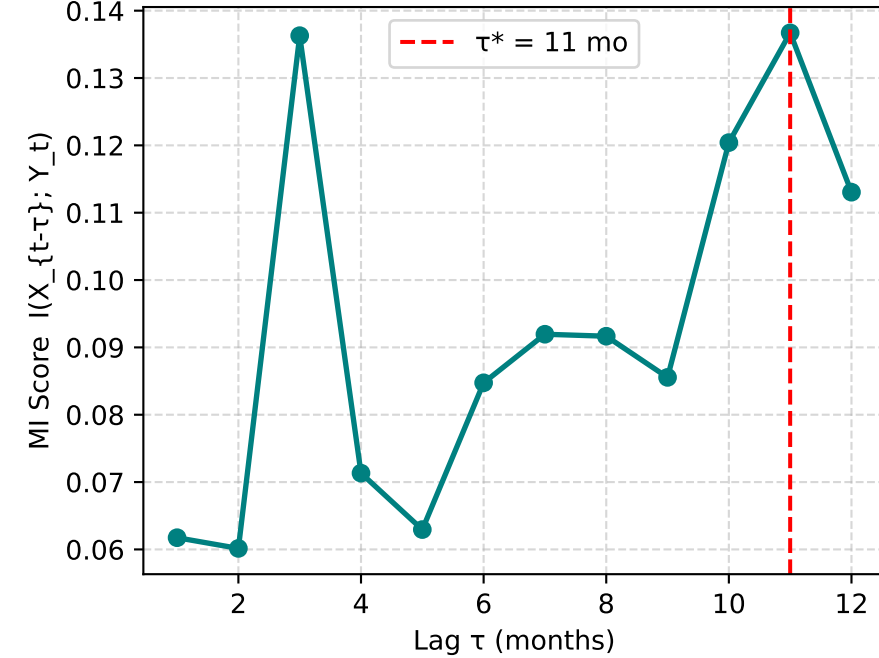
Albany



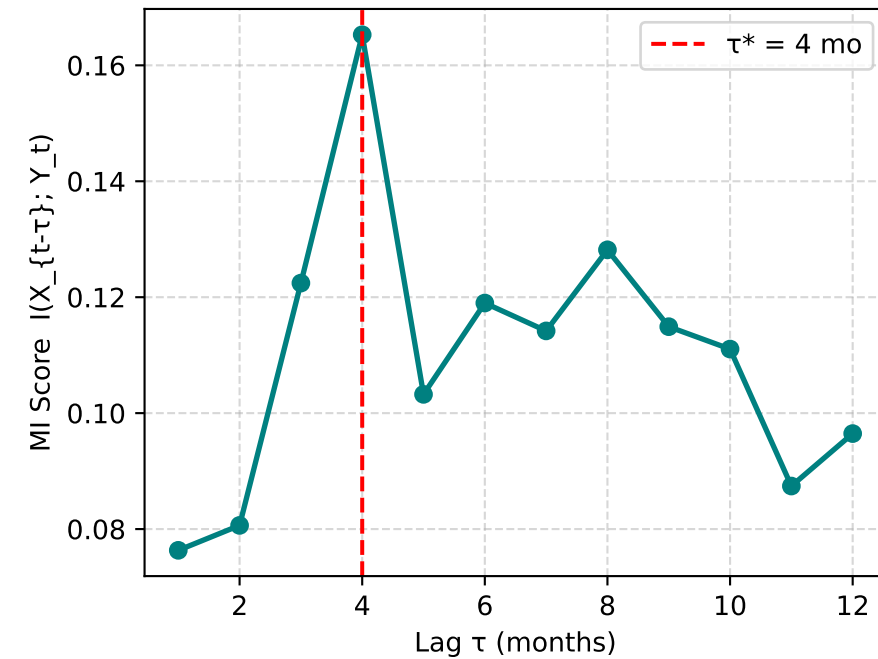
Rensselaer



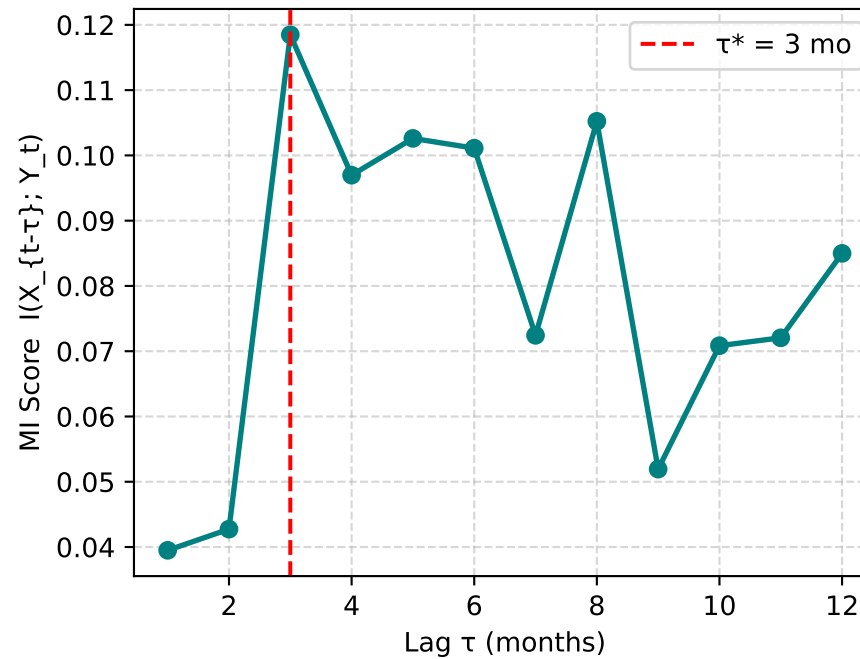
Saratoga



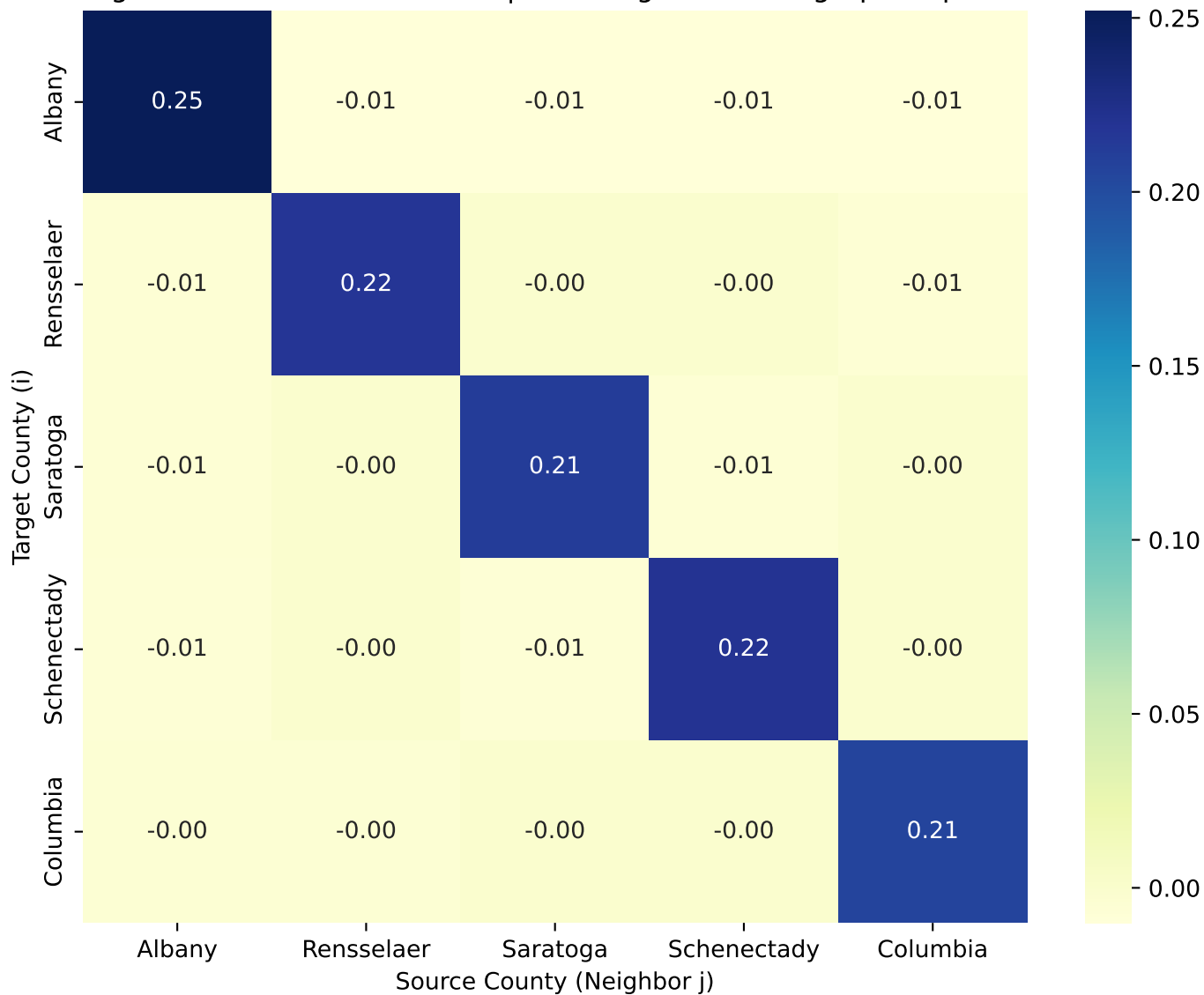
Schenectady



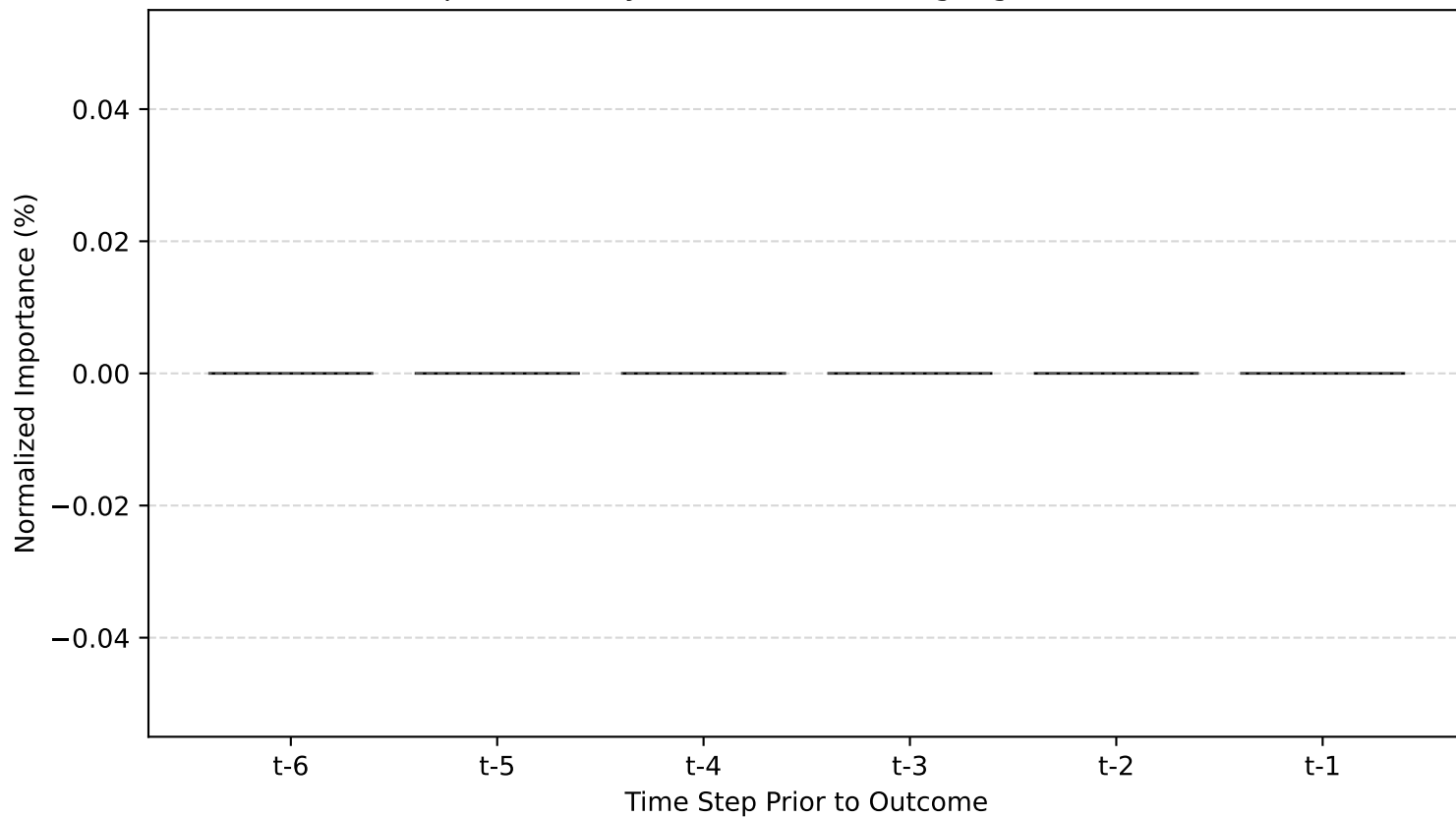
Columbia



Phase 2 — Learned Attention Weights α_{ij}
 Diagonal = Local ERPO effect | Off-diagonal = Geographic spillover



Temporal Importance of ERPO Signal (Gradient Saliency on ERPO Feature)
Optimal Delay $\tau^* = 6$ months (highlighted in red)



ERPO Low Spatio-Temporal Analysis – Summary Report

PHASE 1: CROSS-LAGGED MI – OPTIMAL DELAY τ^*

```
-----  
Albany      :  $\tau^* = 5$  months  
Rensselaer  :  $\tau^* = 3$  months  
Saratoga    :  $\tau^* = 11$  months  
Schenectady :  $\tau^* = 4$  months  
Columbia    :  $\tau^* = 3$  months
```

PHASE 2: GRADIENT SALIENCY (ERPO feature)

```
-----  
 $\tau^* = 6$  months (ground truth injected = 3)
```

SPATIAL SPILLOVERS – Learned α_{ij} Weights:

(Diagonal = local effect, off-diagonal = cross-county spillover)

Albany ← spillover from:

```
Saratoga    :  $\alpha = -0.010$   
Schenectady :  $\alpha = -0.010$   
Rensselaer  :  $\alpha = -0.010$   
Columbia    :  $\alpha = -0.010$ 
```

Rensselaer ← spillover from:

```
Albany      :  $\alpha = -0.006$   
Columbia    :  $\alpha = -0.006$ 
```

Saratoga ← spillover from:

```
Albany      :  $\alpha = -0.005$   
Schenectady :  $\alpha = -0.006$ 
```

Schenectady ← spillover from:

```
Albany      :  $\alpha = -0.006$   
Saratoga    :  $\alpha = -0.006$ 
```

Columbia ← spillover from:

```
Albany      :  $\alpha = -0.004$   
Rensselaer  :  $\alpha = -0.004$ 
```

INTERPRETATION:

- Counties with high off-diagonal α_{ij} are 'Information Hubs' (primary sources of regional ERPO spillover).
- Albany (index 0) was seeded as the spillover hub in this synthetic dataset; high α from Albany to neighbors confirms the model learned the injected spatial signal.